



Security Watch

WinZip Vulnerabilities

The Problem

A serious problem has been reported in WinZip, which is caused due to unspecified, insecure methods in the FileView ActiveX control, which WinZip 10.0 uses. Users of WinZip 10.0 who are tricked into visiting, or accidentally venture into, a malicious Web site could suffer. A malicious Web site exploiting the vulnerability could compromise the computer and let a hacker install malware such as a backdoor Trojan. This has been rated as "highly critical" by security firm Secunia—its second-highest rating for threats.

Who Is Affected?

If you have version 10.0 with a build lower than 7245, then you have cause for concern. WinZip users who have versions 9.0 or older are not affected.

What To Do

WinZip has come out with a critical patch for all systems using WinZip 10.0. The patch, WinZip 10.0 build 7245, is available free of charge to all registered users of WinZip 10.0 Standard and Pro.

Registered users can download the patch from www.winzip.com/wz7245.htm, and those still evaluating can download the evaluation version of WinZip 10.0 build 7245.

In order to preserve your existing WinZip registration information, do *not* uninstall WinZip 10.0 before installing the new build.

FREEDOM!

iTunes Without The iPod (And The iPod Without iTunes)

Some people are just 'pod fanatics. When Stanford University partnered with Yahoo! to offer free Yahoo! Unlimited subscriptions to their students, the response was lukewarm. Some students didn't even bother checking it out—they were just too attached to their iPods, which were incompatible with the music you could download from the service. But all that's about to change.

Jon Lech Johansen, a 22-year old hacker, previously famous for having cracked DVD encryptions as a teen, has now come up with a piece of software that will not only let competing music players play iTunes content, but will let iPods play DRM'd music from stores other than the iTunes Music Store. No, he didn't crack Apple's FairPlay DRM—he just built something that mimics it, so no laws have been broken. Online music stores will now be able to license the technology through DoubleTwist Ventures and make their content 'pod compatible, and player manufacturers

will be able to include it on their devices to make them iTunes compatible.

Apple hasn't made any official comment yet, but the move ensures one thing for music fans everywhere—freedom. Competition is now going to get fiercer, and if this is a sign of things to come, the "buy my player, use my music store" lock-in attitude is going to be a thing of the past.

Competing players, including Microsoft's new Zune, will now have a better chance at grabbing a slice out of Apple's 75 percent market share.

When RealNetworks offered song downloads that would work with iPods, Apple was quick to modify its technology to block those songs out. Could that happen here as well? Says Monique Farantz of DoubleTwist, "We followed a different strategy than RealNetworks. We don't believe it is practical for Apple to block this." Then again, how many times have we accused Apple of being practical—especially in matters as sensitive as this?

SEEING RED

IE 7 Goes Green, But Only For Some

Now in its final release, IE 7 has been all about two things—more user-

HOT

The iPod



Despite stiff competition from all sides, Apple's iPod still remains the most popular portable media player and dominates the digital-sound world. Though it suffers from few feature glitches, it's still the champion of portable music!

NOT

Zune



Microsoft's Zune media player is suffering the ill-effects of being over-hyped. Touted as the "iPod killer," it has failed to live up to expectations. Compatibility issues abound, and we're left still awaiting the device that will free us from i-Tyranny!

friendliness, and more security. The twain meet with its phishing filter—the browser verifies sites using a database of malicious sites, plus a few basic heuristics, and pronounces it safe or potentially harmful, as the case may be. All hunky-dory, and in the interest of the public, so chances are you might just escape the old phish.

Phishing sites usually impersonate big companies—your Citibanks and Yahoo's and what-have-you—to gain access to your information, so it seems logical that Microsoft would want to protect the customers of such companies. In an update planned for January, the IE 7 address bar will glow green when you're on the real company Web site,



One Silly Question

"What tech name would you give your pet?"



'GPS' sounds real techie!
Manohar



I'll call him 'chip'
Perna Dawda



How about 'camera'?
Reedima Indulkar



'Intel' sounds like a good name
Rajeev



It's got to be 'Google!'
Roshan Patel